

TEXTBOOK ADOPTION

Loudoun County School Board provides a wide variety of instructional resources to support and enrich the educational program. The Code of Virginia defines textbooks as the print or electronic media for student use that serve as the primary curriculum basis for a grade-level subject or course. While the Virginia Board of Education sets forth a textbook review and adoption process for the core subject areas of English/Language Arts, Mathematics, Science, and Social Science & Global Studies, the Code of Virginia permits the School Board to use textbooks not approved by the Virginia Board of Education for these core subjects and other subjects through an established local textbook review process that is conducted by similar processes to the state-level review. This policy sets forth the School Board's established local textbook review process.

LCPS content offices will review textbook and related digital resources listed on approved VDOE lists and/or request proposals from all known publishers and providers through an RFP process.

A. Guiding Principles. Loudoun County Public School's local textbook adoption process is conducted in compliance with the Virginia Board of Education Regulations and Virginia Code. Guidance from the Virginia Department of Education stipulates a seven-year adoption cycle with staff and parent involvement in the adoption process. Because the textbook is a key instructional tool for the teachers, three guiding principles are honored by the local adoption process in Loudoun County Public Schools:

1. Textbook Review Committee Composition. The textbook review committee shall be composed of classroom teachers, school administrators, parents, and community members, and will work in collaboration with content supervisors. The committee will have the primary role in setting the selection criteria, reviewing textbooks and making recommendations for adoption. All review committee members participate equally in the review process. Teachers are charged with the direct responsibility for delivering the curriculum to students and therefore, should hold a majority membership on the committee.

2. Responsibility of Textbook Review Committee. It is the responsibility of the textbook review committee to determine the text(s) which best support the curriculum and to make a recommendation to the Superintendent for adoption by the School Board. It is not the responsibility of the textbook review committee to determine or modify curriculum. That responsibility falls upon content supervisors and curriculum committees to conduct the review, research, and lengthy consideration necessary in determining the content to be taught and the appropriate grade levels for introduction and development of that content.

3. Textbooks Support Curriculum. Textbooks are resources to complement the curriculum. The review committee makes recommendations for resources to match

TEXTBOOK ADOPTION

specific course and instructional goals that align with the LCPS curriculum. Adopted resources do not influence or set the curriculum, but rather, support it.

B. Recommendation to the Superintendent. The textbook review committee will take the following steps prior to making a recommendation to the Superintendent for adoption by the School Board. These steps are detailed in Regulation [5130-REG](#).

1. Establish selection criteria.
2. Screen available textbooks based on the selection criteria.
3. Give notice to parents and community members that textbooks under consideration will be made available at designated locations for review.
4. Create procedures to ensure appropriate consideration of parent and community member comments.

C. School Board Textbook Adoption. The Loudoun County School Board is responsible for adoption of textbooks. The School Board will adopt textbooks based on final recommendations of the Superintendent and the textbook review committee.

[Former Policy 5-19]
Adopted: 11/12/1996
Revised: 10/13/09, 12/3/19
Current Revision: 12/10/24

Legal Ref: [Code of Virginia §22.1-238](#), [Virginia Administrative Code §8VAC-720-170](#)
Cross Ref: Regulation [5130-REG](#), Textbook Adoption